

Russell Dudek

Candidate for Director, AI Operations

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>

Dear Ontra Hiring Team,

Ontra is not hiring someone to explain that AI matters. You are hiring the person who can turn distributed demand into a company capability: a roadmap grounded in business outcomes, hands-on workflow implementation, training that changes behavior, a useful community of practice, and governance that makes safe execution faster rather than slower.

That combination is the through-line of my work. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, training, and accountability. Through DudeWorth, I develop AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks and design agentic workflow patterns with structured context, retrieval, human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and governance rails. At Amazon, I built launch and operating mechanisms in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. Earlier, at Compunetics, I led engineering, manufacturing, quality, and high-reliability technical work where process controls and evidence were inseparable from execution.

My candidate vision for this role is built around an AI Precedent Bench: a practical mechanism for evaluating departmental cases against value, retained human authority, tool and data boundaries, enablement ownership, and proof. The purpose is not to centralize every automation. It is to ensure that each successful case leaves behind a clearer workflow, stronger local capability, and a reusable operating precedent.

The full candidate vision and 120-day approach are available at <https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss where AI demand is already strongest inside Ontra, which decisions currently create the most friction, and what would make this capability credible six months after launch.

Carpe diem,
Russell Dudek